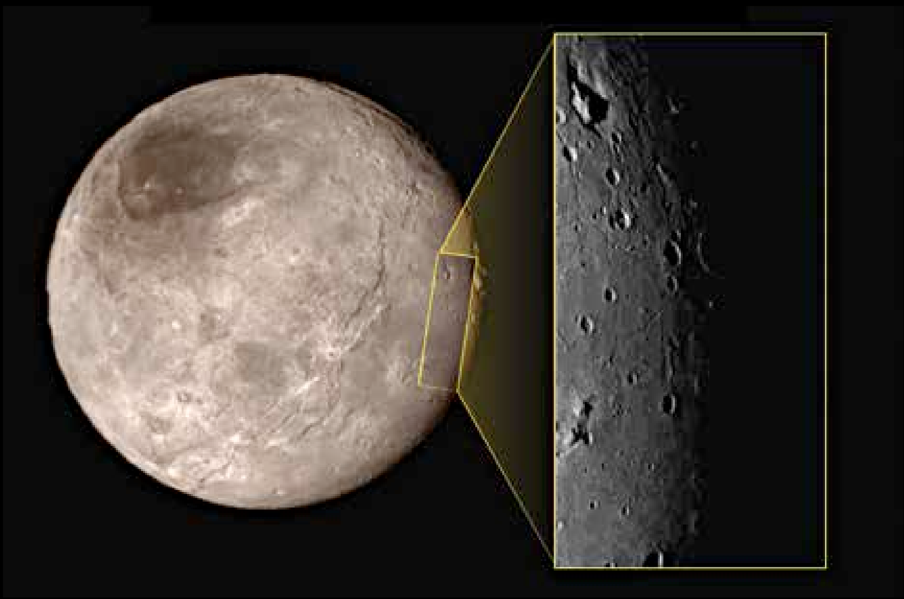
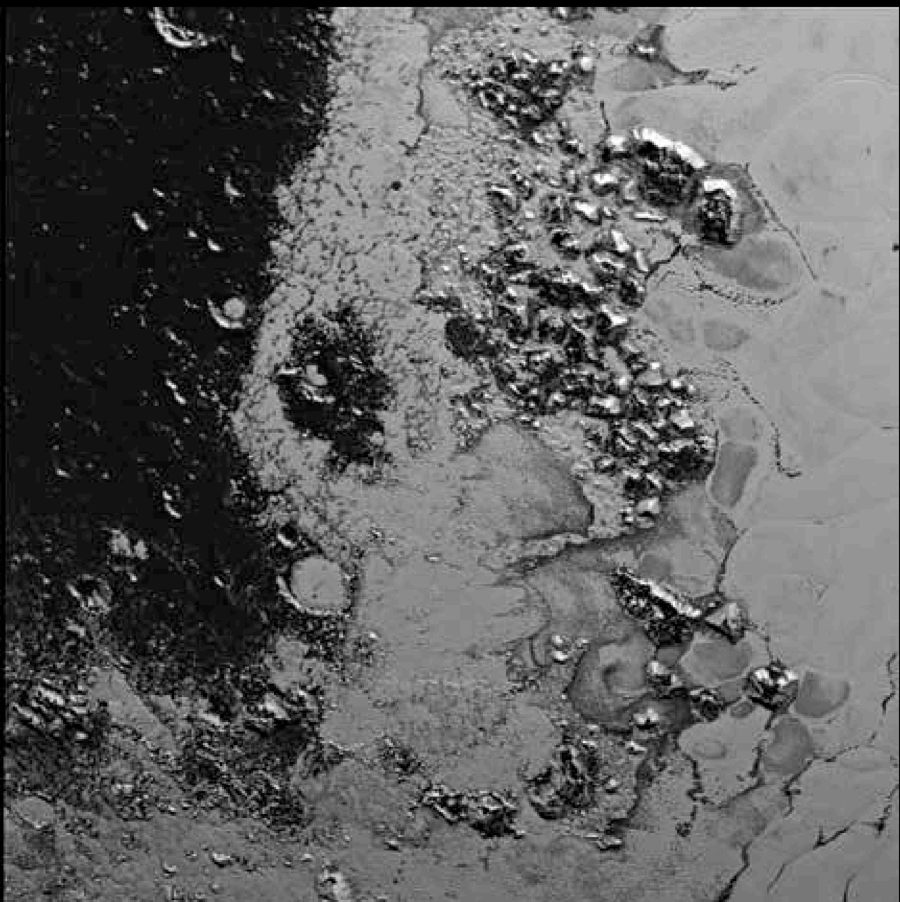
**Hail Hydra!**
See the first glimpse of Pluto's outermost moon - Hydra captured from a distance of 645,000km. **http://dgit.in/1MrRy6o**

**Pluto on Pluto?**
Yes, we're talking about how a huge portion of Pluto's surface look's like Walt Disney's Pluto the cartoon character. **http://dgit.in/1OCpknE**





This is Pluto's moon Charon, which has also being studied closely by New Horizons. While we wait for data to be downloaded, there's a very interesting feature that has geologists scratching their heads! What is that mountain inside a moat on the top left of the zoomed in image? Wow!
Image Credit: NASA/JHUAPL/SWRI



NASA's Deep Space Web receives data from New Horizons at just 1 or 2 Kbps, because it's 3 billion miles away (ever increasing). Imagine how slowly this breathtaking image of mountain ranges on Pluto was downloaded. Now you know why there are only updates once a week or less from NASA.
Image Credit: NASA/JHUAPL/SWRI

## It's active!

Traditionally, we've thought of cold icy bodies that orbit beyond Neptune as too far away from the Sun to have any significant warmth, and also no big gravitational influencers to cause surface disturbances such as the type we see on Io (Jupiter's moon).

The very first images of Pluto have shown that there are flat plains on the surface, with no visible craters, suggesting that the surface has been re-formed (in some way). Bodies like our own Moon are covered with craters because they're geologically dead, and thus there's nothing changing the surface. For Pluto to have crater-less plains, we have to believe that the surface itself is "new". We put new in quotes because on the time scale of the solar system, it probably means that the craterless bits of Pluto were re-surfaced in the last 100 million years!

## We love you too!

The first compressed images we got of Pluto as the spacecraft approached the dwarf planet showed a very distinct plain, that was oddly shaped a lot like a Valentine heart! It's almost as if Pluto was saying, "Welcome! I love you!" And obviously the world replied, "We love you too Pluto!"

## Mountains?

Yes, Pluto has mountains! They're large enough to be considered mountains back here on Earth! Nothing like the Himalayas or anything (yet), but they're comparable to the Rocky mountains in the US. As more data is gathered over the coming months, NASA will release more and more information that will show us more and more of Pluto's surface.

What's interesting, however, is that none of the icy compounds we've suspected that make up Pluto can be stable mountains, even with the low gravity on Pluto. Well, except water ice. So early predictions are that these are water ice mountains, and we can't wait for the artists' renditions of Pluto's surface that are sure to begin surfacing over the next few months. Whatever the case, Pluto has captured our imagination and made us look into outer space once again. Along with the recent news of the discovery of an Earth-like planet (Kepler-452b), these are exciting times for us space enthusiasts!